18F

🏁 🔐 🏁 **FRONT MATTER** 🏁 🔐 🏁

All 18F teams are expected to maintain a README of key information, allowing new teammates and leadership to quickly gain context on the project.

The team should update the README upon a new project phase, like the end of discovery.

This is a recommended README template; it can be adapted to suit the team.

Suggestions? Contact: 18F Director of Account Management

Project README — Welcome to [PROJECT NAME]!

Last updated: xx/xx/202x

Partner agency:
Project start date:
Projected end date:
Tock code:

Links

- Project folder
- Slack channel
- Burn document

- Running notes doc
- Arising questions doc
- BD Qualification (internal)
- BD Proposal to partner
- IAA / Statement of Work
- Team charter
- Risk tracker
- Task tracker
- Project plan or high-level schedule
- Weekly ship record
- Launch plan
- Mural space
- Related partner satisfaction interviews, if any:
- Engagement brief:[TEMPLATE] 18F Big Picture Engagement Brief: [Partner name] [Project name]
- Project Resources Airtable

Mission

What is our partner's mission? Who do they serve?

Impact

What's the ultimate impact headline we want to contribute to? e.g. "Partner can issue passports in one week or less."

Challenges

What problems are our partners facing? What have our partners done to work around their challenges?

Deliverables

What has the partner indicated they need by the end of this engagement? What deliverables are listed in the Statement of Work?

Timing

Why is the partner coming to 18F now?

Intake path

Did 18F identify this lead, or did the partner come to us?

Project shape

Strategy development (formerly Path Analysis/Discovery)
Vendor acquisition support
Website modernization
Digital service transformation
Other (custom shape)

Risks

Link to risk tracker here.

Partner details

Key contacts

Name	Title	Organization	Contact

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💡 **Partner communication tips**:
Add any information about how the partners prefer to communicate. What video meeting technologies work best for them? Will they need GACA accounts?

Product owner and executive sponsor

How much time do they have to dedicate to this project? How does the executive sponsor want to be involved?

Other stakeholders

Are there third-party stakeholders funding this work or watching the outcome — e.g. TMF, White House?

Office culture and structure

Do we have documentation on the office structure, such as an org chart? Are there any known naysayers for this work?

User research

How could the partner go about recruiting users for user research?

Technology environment

What is the current tech stack? Include any relevant technology documentation.

Access to systems and data

Is there anything the team needs to do to gain credentials or get access?

Partner communication tools

Communication type	Preferred platform	Notes
File sharing (Drive, teams, dropbox)		
Video meetings (Meet, zoom, teams)		
Written conversation (Slack, teams, email)		
Visual collaboration (Mural, others)		

Relationship with IT/security

What is the program office's relationship with the CIO shop? What is the process for launching a site, application, or new piece of software?

Procurement

What is the program office's relationship with its procurement shop? What is the process like for procuring a piece of software?

Vendors

Are there existing vendor teams in place? How are they performing and what is the partner's relationship with the vendors like?

Agile practices

Does the partner release changes regularly or frequently? Has anyone received agile or scrum training?

Background reading

Has the partner shared any important documents or resources? e.g. reports, background materials, prior research?